

Your name:

# The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

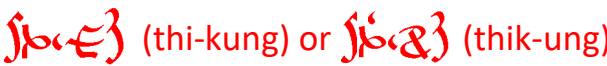
## Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 30)

- Q.2.1: 1 point for each correct letter (max 18)
- Q.2.2: 2 points for each correct Lepcha word; 1 point with one error (max 6)
- Q.2.3: 2 points for each correct transliteration; 1 with one error (max 6)

|       |                                                                                                |   |   |   |   |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| Q.2.1 | 1                                                                                              | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 |
|       | J                                                                                              | F | A | Q | C | R | D                                                                                                                                                                                                   | N | H | M  | G  | I  | B  | O  | K  | L  | E  | P  |
| Q.2.2 | chóng ‘hand’                                                                                   |   |   |   |   |   |                                                                                                                    |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|       | jik ‘native land’                                                                              |   |   |   |   |   |                                                                                                                   |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|       | thikúng ‘great-grandfather’                                                                    |   |   |   |   |   |  (thi-kung) or  (thik-ung) |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
| Q.2.3 |  ‘to crack’ |   |   |   |   |   | dan                                                                                                                                                                                                 |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|       |  ‘to read’  |   |   |   |   |   | rok                                                                                                                                                                                                 |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|       |  ‘elephant’ |   |   |   |   |   | ranmo                                                                                                                                                                                               |   |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |

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### Commentary

1. Writing direction is left to right.
2. The writing system is of a type called 'abjad', in which the main characters stand only for consonants, and vowels are either not shown at all or are shown by extra marks ('diacritics').
3. Syllable-initial consonants are written with full letters:

𐌀 *k*-, 𐌁 *kh*-, 𐌂 *ch*-, 𐌃 *t*-, 𐌄 *th*-, 𐌅 *d*-, 𐌆 *b*-, 𐌇 *ts*-, 𐌈 *r*-, 𐌉 *l*-

If there is no initial consonant, the null initial 𐌀 is used instead.

4. Vowels are marked by symbols to the left of, below, or to the right of consonants:

𐌀𐌁 *ke*, 𐌀𐌁𐌃 *ki*, (𐌀𐌁𐌆 *ko*, (𐌀𐌁𐌇 *kó*, 𐌀𐌁) *ku*, 𐌀𐌁} *kú*

If there is no vowel mark, by default the vowel *a* is used: 𐌀𐌁 *ka*.

5. Syllable-final consonants are written with symbols above or to the left of the consonant-vowel block:

𐌀𐌁̇ *kak*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌃 *kan*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌆 *kat*, 𐌀𐌁̇𐌇 *kang*

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From <http://www.ancientscripts.com/lepcha.html>:

Basic letters with vowel = /a/:



Other vowels:



Final consonants:



Consonant clusters are also possible, but not relevant to this problem.